

TURBOCHARGE YOUR GAME EXPERIENCE

SLI

Scalable Link Interface is NVIDIA's multi GPU technology. It's no secret that this technology is focused towards power users. The average consumer has no need for multiple GPUs. With multiple GPUs comes the



task of processes scaling properly. This task is more dependant upon the particular application that is utilising the GPUs. NVIDIA releases drivers on a regular basis to keep up with the multitude of applications that require more powerful processing solutions. Whenever a new game is released NVIDIA releases new drivers which enables better scaling. However, SLI can also provide for an economical way to increase performance for the average user. By getting a GPU of the same series as the one currently owned rather than going in for the newest card on the market, a user can gain a great performance boost for much less cost. *STALKER: Call of Pripjat* showed an performance increase of over 100%. Right now one can use 4 graphics cards in Quad-SLI configuration. By using the right profile one can achieve much higher performance, what's more is that you can create your own profile using NVIDIA's control panel or you could use Coolbits to tweak your graphics cards.

WE TRY TO DEMYSTIFY CERTAIN GRAPHICS SPHERE RELATED JARGON AND TELL YOU HOW THEY ENHANCE YOUR OVERALL GAMING EXPERIENCE

ANTI-ALIASING

NVIDIA's latest anti-aliasing algorithm is called FXAA (Fast Approximate Anti-Aliasing). It is a single-pass pixel shader which runs in the post-processing stage. Compared to older algorithms, it is faster, uses less memory while compromising in precision and quality. It has been shown to offer better results than 4xAA using older gen algorithms. The technology is not specific to NVIDIA's GPUs alone, its competitors can make use of the algorithm too as it is independent of any GPU API. FXAA has the logic to reduce single pixel and sub-pixel aliasing which is usually evident by flickering. FXAA can be used to vary the contrast of single pixel and sub-pixel elements. Also FXAA is title specific, thus giving the game developers to choose as to how the algorithm must be applied. Since the higher rendering speed comes at the cost of losing quality, the developer can make an informed decision as to where they can perform the trade-off over quality. There are multiple versions of FXAA, the latest iteration has two versions, one for PC and the other for consoles. Overall, this higher control offers a much better visual treat.

